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Set up recruitment

Astral customer discovery
Activity 2 of 7 · Draft for review · October 2026

Activity 2
Set up recruitment



Purpose 03

What happens 05

Recruitment 06–07

Schedule 09

Objectives 10

Consent and data 11

Risks 12

Output 13

ACTIVITY 2 OF 7

Set up recruitment

Reach the people who actually do the work, across several organisations.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

2 to 3 weeks, alongside stage 1

DEPENDS ON

Access coordinator. Privacy owner sign-off

OUTPUT

Access coordinator, screener, matrix, consent approach, and first bookings.

WHAT WE NEED FROM REVIEWERS

- **Name an access coordinator.** Someone who can introduce us to customers and book sessions.
- **Access to the people who do the work.** Not only senior account contacts.
- **A privacy and data-protection owner.** To agree recording, transcription, storage, and any AI processing before the first session.

THE SEVEN ACTIVITIES

1	Agree scope and decisions
2	**Set up recruitment**
3	Discovery round 1
4	Discovery round 2, targeted
5	Survey
6	Integrate and follow up
7	Test design implications

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

How do IMSERV customers do their energy-data work today, and which differences in that work should change how Astral is designed and prioritised?

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What happens

What happens

Reach the people who actually do the work, across several organisations.

1

Access coordinator

Named access coordinator for customer introductions.

2

Screener

Short behavioural screener.

3

Matrix and tracker

Recruitment matrix and tracker. Participant coverage and organisation coverage.

4

Consent and data

Consent, recording, storage, and AI-processing approach agreed with the privacy owner.

5

First bookings

First sessions booked.

Recruitment matrix

We will not try to fill every combination. We prioritise contrasts likely to change a design decision, then recruit into gaps as findings emerge.

Dimension	Examples
Activities actually performed	Investigating data, reconciling figures, reporting, managing access, resolving service issues
Frequency and experience	Regular, occasional, newly onboarded, experienced
Scale and complexity	One site or a portfolio. Simple or several organisational relationships
Working relationships	Direct customer work, or delegated and intermediary work such as Broker / TPI
Service experience	Works well, repeated difficulty, gave up, or relies on someone else
Tools and channels	Portal, spreadsheet, email, API, telephone, and combinations
Access needs	Assistive technology, magnification, digital confidence, other support needs

Who we recruit

In business services, separate the buyer, administrator, practitioner, approver, and recipient of outputs. A senior contact may not do the everyday work.

STARTING POINT

Energy, Finance, Asset, and Data hats are a starting point for screening. They are not the archetypes.

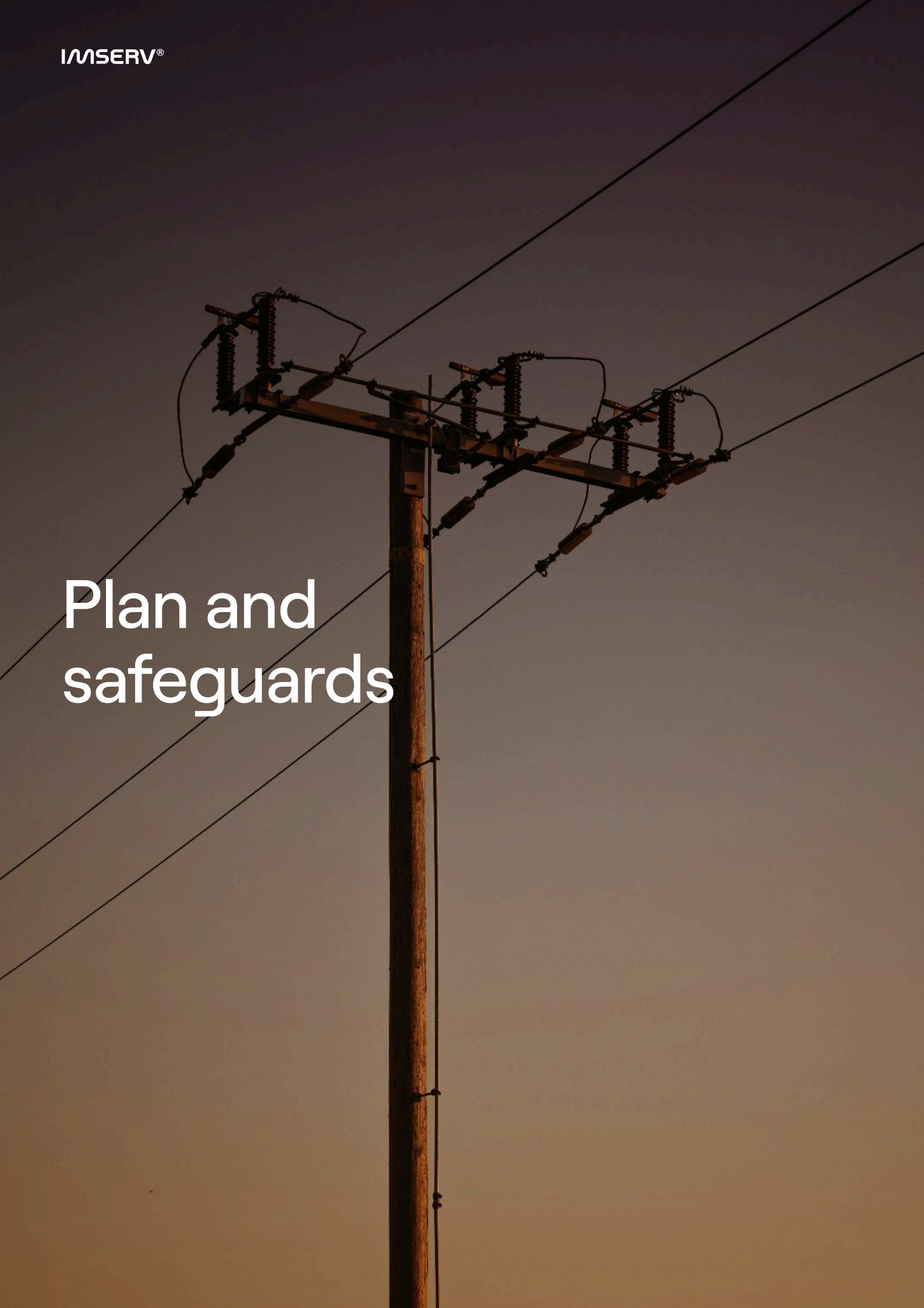
NOT A STAND-IN

Account managers and internal experts help with recruitment and service context. They do not stand in for customer practitioners.

EXCLUSIONS

IMSERV staff standing in for customers. People who designed the flows being discussed.

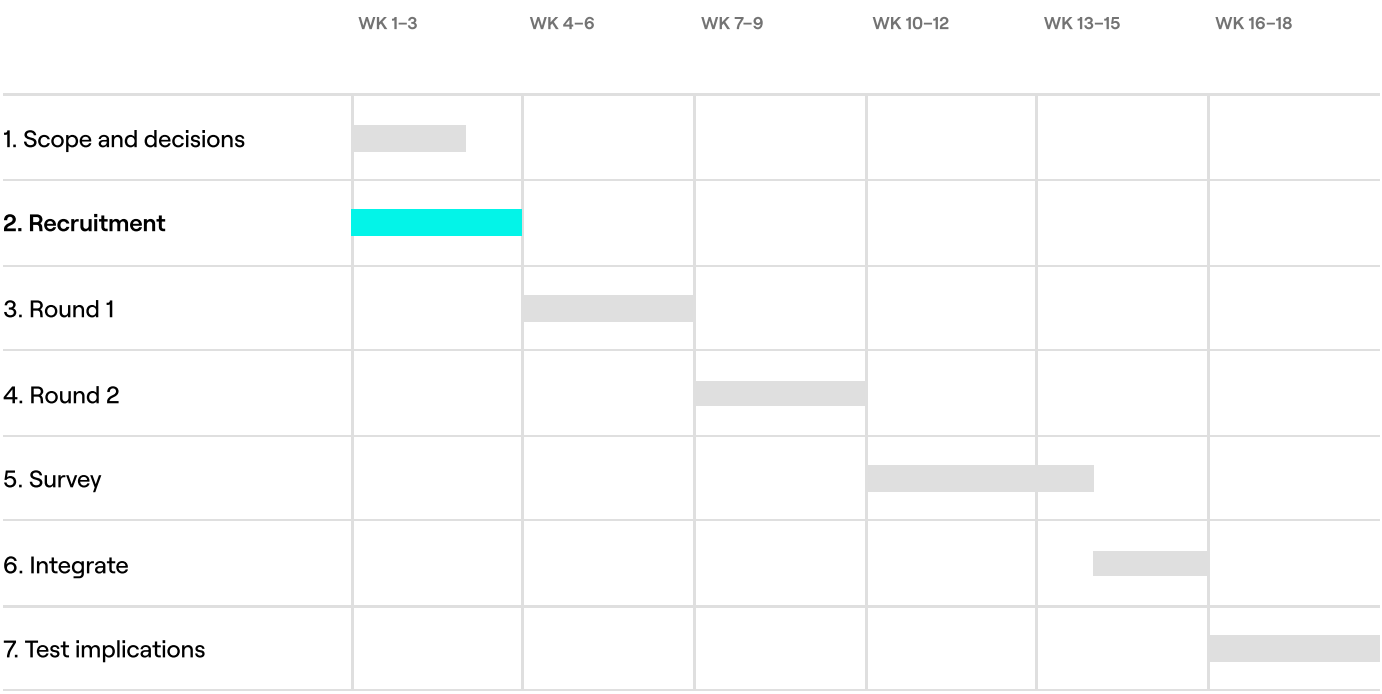
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Plan and safeguards

Where it sits

Estimates to agree, not commitments. Bars show the upper estimate for each stage. With overlap, roughly 12 to 18 weeks from agreement to tested implications.



Stage	Provisional duration	Depends on
2. Set up recruitment	2 to 3 weeks, alongside stage 1	Access coordinator. Privacy owner sign-off

What we are asking for

This plan is the proposal for the conversation with Clive. He has **not** agreed a research plan, scope, or sample size.

	Ask	Status
3	**Name an access coordinator.** Someone who can introduce us to customers and book sessions.	To agree
4	**Access to the people who do the work.** Not only senior account contacts.	To agree
6	**A privacy and data-protection owner.** To agree recording, transcription, storage, and any AI processing before the first session.	To agree

Decision to inform

- Which customer tasks and journeys Astral should prioritise for version one and after.
- Which behavioural differences need different designs, defaults, or trade-offs.
- Where problems sit in the service and process, not the interface. So we do not try to fix ownership or data quality with screen copy.
- What the BA team should specify next, with evidence behind each story.

None of this is a finding yet

Everything here is a proposed approach. It is grounded in UX and mixed-methods guidance. **None of it is a finding about IMSERV customers yet.**

Neutral draft. No consent wording is sent until it is approved. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent, privacy and data

Agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session.

Every session

- Informed consent for every participant before the session
- Recording, transcription, storage, retention, and any AI processing agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session
- Approved storage with restricted access. Raw recordings and transcripts stay restricted
- Customer documents shown in walkthroughs are redacted or not kept, as agreed
- Participants are P01, P02 in analysis. Removing names alone may not anonymise a distinctive business account
- Quotes in shared outputs only with consent for anonymised quotation
- No consent wording is sent until it is approved. The current wording is a neutral draft

How AI is used

Copilot can help organise approved material, suggest candidate patterns, and keep evidence links up to date. Only within what the privacy owner approves.

It will **not** invent quotes, build archetypes from job titles, or treat simulated customers as evidence.

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
Introductions only reach senior contacts	We hear about the work, not from the people doing it	Ask for practitioners by the activity they do. Track who does what in the screener
Participants come from one or two organisations	Shared local process looks like a pattern	Track organisation coverage. Recruit across several
Recruitment or privacy approval is slow	The timeline moves	Start both in stage 1. Share early findings from round 1
Twelve interviews are treated as enough	A multi-role audience is under-covered	Plan rounds, not a total. Keep recruiting while important gaps remain

Access coordinator, screener, matrix, consent approach, and first bookings.

Output

Early findings reach the BA team from round 1, not only at the end.

Hands over to

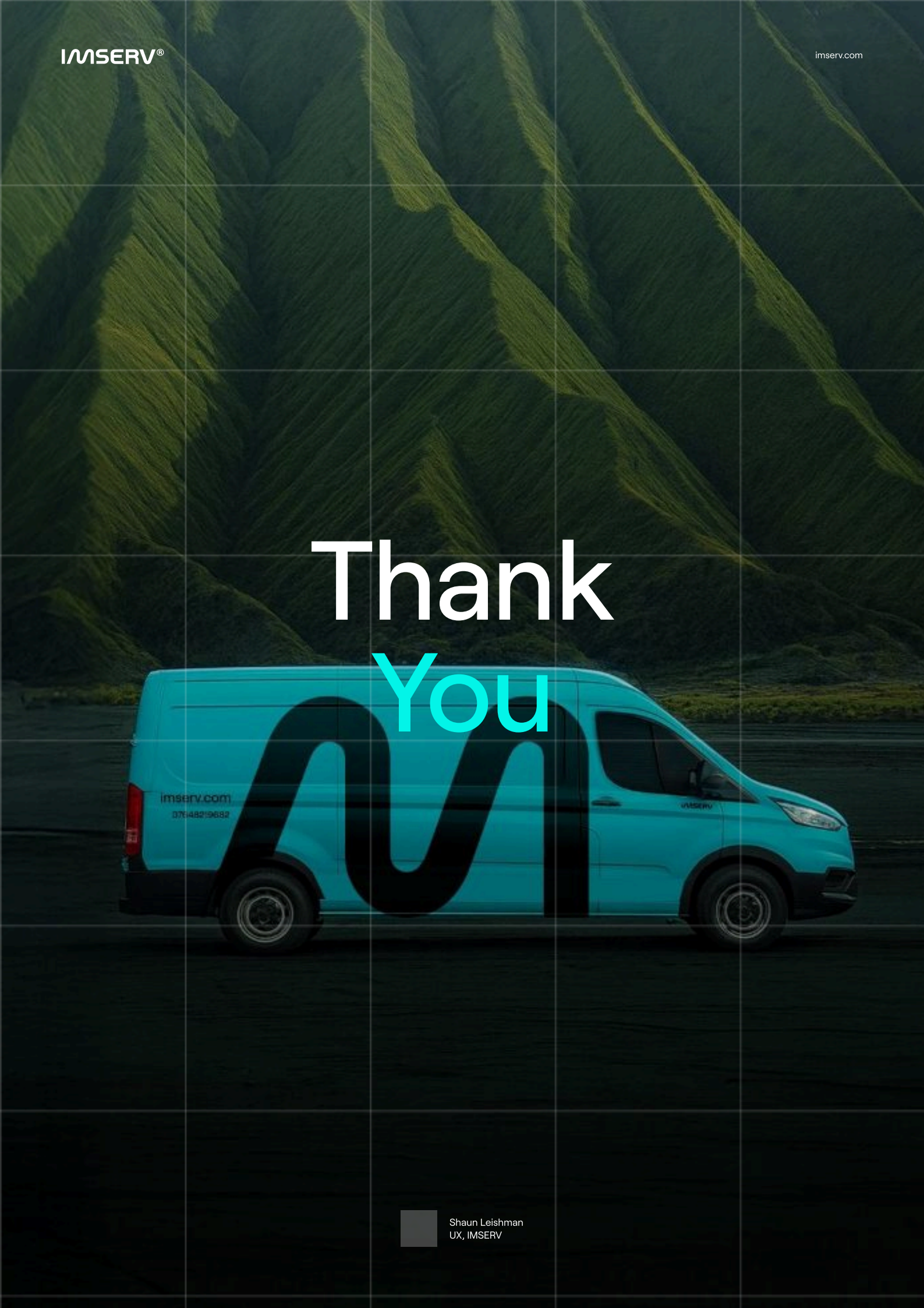
Activity 3. Discovery round 1.

Understand real, recent episodes of work before showing any proposed screens.

Working alongside the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2

Thank You



Shaun Leishman
UX, IMSERV